

Transporting Cuisines to New Settings



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Before continuing with this section, make sure you have read the article by Popper assigned for this module.

We have seen, in the example of the Romans above, how important cultural preferences for foods were in the spread of societies and cuisines across large areas. The Roman soldiers stationed along Hadrian's Wall in northern England wanted the wine, dates, peaches, and spices prized in their cuisine and so brought these plants with them thousands of kilometers north of where those foods were produced. We see similar trade in foods today, as "ethnic" grocery stores across the US cater to immigrants from different parts of the world, with Ethiopian, Ukrainian, Chinese, and Indian grocery stores in Allston alone! But how did immigrants manage to retain their food culture centuries and millennia ago, before well-developed global trade networks shipped goods predictably and consistently everywhere in the world?



Hadrian's Wall, northern England.

Source: [Wikimedia Commons](https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Section_of_Hadrian%27s_Wall_1.jpg)

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